CYBER THREAT INTELLIGENCE

IP Indicator Investigation Report

Case study: ClickFix social engineering campaign delivering Vidar Stealer via a fake Cloudflare CAPTCHA page

Scope	Four IPv4 indicators from a public OTX campaign pulse
Reference report	FDC Threat Intelligence report dated 27 March 2026
Investigation date	6 November 2026
Sources	VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB, AlienVault OTX (portal results supplied during investigation)
Purpose	SOC / CTI learning and portfolio submission

Purpose

This report documents passive reputation and threat-intelligence checks for four IPv4 indicators listed in the referenced ClickFix/Vidar campaign pulse. It records portal observations, interprets conflicting signals, and identifies limitations before assigning a final disposition.

> **Scope limitation:** This document covers the four IPv4 indicators only. The campaign pulse also lists four domains, three SHA-256 hashes and two URLs, which have not yet been independently investigated in this workflow. This report does not claim completion of the full 15-IOC assignment.

1. Executive Summary

Four IPv4 indicators were reviewed using VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB and AlienVault OTX. Results are mixed: one IP has a higher VirusTotal detection count; one has a non-zero AbuseIPDB confidence score and many reports; two are identified as Cloudflare reverse-proxy/CDN addresses and are whitelisted by AbuseIPDB and OTX.

The campaign pulse lists all four addresses. Inclusion in a public campaign IOC list is useful context, but does not by itself prove that every IP is malicious infrastructure. Shared hosting and CDN addresses require domain- or URL-level context. No IP is labelled confirmed malicious in this report.

1.1 At-a-glance results

78.46.199.184	9/92	0%; no reports	1 campaign pulse; 0 on indicator page	Hetzner; AS24940; Germany	Suspicious; corroborate
213.186.33.16	0/92	29%; 74 reports / 31 reporters	50	OVH; AS16276; France	Mixed reputation
172.67.148.28	1/92	0%; 7 reports / 3 reporters	25	Cloudflare; AS13335; CDN	Shared CDN; context needed
104.21.55.125	0/92	0%; 8 reports / 3 reporters	22	Cloudflare; AS13335; CDN	Shared CDN; context needed

1.2 Key analytical cautions

• Detection ratios are point-in-time results and may differ between platforms and feeds.
• AbuseIPDB report counts are not equivalent to its confidence score.
• OTX pulse counts are association counts, not maliciousness scores.
• Cloudflare and other hosting-provider IPs are shared infrastructure; investigate hostname, URL, DNS history and timestamps before considering a block.
• Antivirus labels displayed on OTX do not prove that the IP itself hosted or executed the named malware.

2. Methodology and Evidence Handling

The investigation used passive lookups only. No suspicious IP or domain was directly visited, scanned or contacted, and no malware sample was downloaded or executed.

2.1 Sources and interpretation limits

VirusTotal	Detection ratio supplied for each IP.	0 detections does not establish safety; ratio is a snapshot.
AbuseIPDB	Confidence score, reports, reporters, latest report, ISP, usage type, ASN, hostname, location, whitelist context.	Reports may relate to other activity on shared infrastructure; read score and count together.
AlienVault OTX	Pulse count, campaign pulse, verdict, classification, DNS/URL/file counts, tags, AV labels and ASN.	Pulse counts/tags are context, not proof of malicious activity.

2.2 Campaign reference

OTX pulse title: **[FDC] ClickFix Social Engineering Campaign Delivering Vidar Stealer via Fake Cloudflare CAPTCHA**. Pulse creator shown: afokin52. The pulse referenced an FDC Threat Intelligence report dated 27 March 2026.

Public report: https://github.com/freedatacenter/threat-intelligence/blob/main/reports/2026-03-27-clickfix-vidar/Incident_Report_2026-03-27_EN.pdf

The pulse indicator table listed four domains, four IPv4 addresses, three SHA-256 hashes and two URLs. This report covers only the four IPv4 indicators.

3.1 Indicator: 78.46.199.184

Working assessment: Suspicious campaign-listed indicator; further corroboration required.

VirusTotal	9/92 vendors flagged
AbuseIPDB	0% confidence; no reports shown Germany; AS24940; Hetzner Online GmbH; network range 78.46.0.0/15.
AlienVault OTX	The IP appeared in the FDC ClickFix/Vidar campaign pulse indicator table. Campaign table showed it as an IPv4 indicator added 11 May 2026. Its indicator page showed 0 related pulses; the campaign pulse itself was identified as one pulse in the user's search. The campaign pulse included malware, stealer, ClickFix, Vidar and social-engineering tags. This workflow did not independently establish a C2 role.
Analyst note	The 9/92 ratio is a follow-up signal but does not independently confirm that this address was a Vidar command-and-control server. No AbuseIPDB reports is not proof of safety.

Evidence interpretation: Inclusion in the public campaign IOC list is not independent confirmation of malicious activity. Correlate with DNS, URL, endpoint and time-based telemetry before taking action.

3.2 Indicator: 213.186.33.16

Working assessment: Mixed reputation; campaign-listed shared hosting infrastructure requiring domain-level context.

VirusTotal	0/92 vendors flagged
AbuseIPDB	29% confidence; 74 reports; 31 reporters; latest report 1 day ago OVH SAS; AS16276; hostname cluster105.hosting.ovh.net; domain ovh.net; Gravelines, France; usage type displayed as CDN.
AlienVault OTX	50 pulses; 500+ passive DNS; 10 URLs; 0 files. OTX verdict Whitelisted; classification Datacenter / Hosting / VPS. The FDC ClickFix/Vidar pulse was confirmed among related pulses. OTX showed 35 domains resolved in 7 days, 139 in 30 days, 500+ all-time and 32 TLDs. OTX AV label: TrojanDownloader:Win32/Cutwail; ratio 6/6. IDS text displayed: 403 Forbidden.
Analyst note	VirusTotal 0/92 conflicts with AbuseIPDB's 29% confidence and OTX pulse/AV information. Whitelisted does not prove benignness. The Cutwail label does not prove this IP is a Cutwail server or part of this campaign.

Evidence interpretation: Inclusion in the public campaign IOC list is not independent confirmation of malicious activity. Correlate with DNS, URL, endpoint and time-based telemetry before taking action.

3.3 Indicator: 172.67.148.28

Working assessment: Campaign-associated shared CDN proxy; do not treat the IP itself as confirmed malicious.

VirusTotal	1/92 vendors flagged
AbuseIPDB	0% confidence; 7 reports; 3 reporters; latest report 7 months ago AbuseIPDB identified a whitelisted Cloudflare reverse proxy in 172.64.0.0/13; Cloudflare, Inc.; CDN; AS13335; San Francisco, US.
AlienVault OTX	25 pulses; 500+ passive DNS; 10 URLs; 4 files. OTX verdict Whitelisted; classification CDN. 500+ domains and 89 TLDs; related tags included malware, stealer, ClickFix and Vidar. OTX showed 56 domains in 7 days and 401 in 30 days. AV labels: Backdoor:Win32/LimeRat.YA!MTB; TrojanDropper:Win32/Muldrop.V!MTB; Win.Packed.Razy-9807129-0; ratio 4/4.
Analyst note	Single VT detection and OTX tags/AV labels must be interpreted in light of Cloudflare's shared proxy role. The underlying hostname and URL are better investigative pivots.

Evidence interpretation: Inclusion in the public campaign IOC list is not independent confirmation of malicious activity. Correlate with DNS, URL, endpoint and time-based telemetry before taking action.

3.4 Indicator: 104.21.55.125

Working assessment: Campaign-associated shared CDN proxy; do not treat the IP itself as confirmed malicious.

VirusTotal	0/92 vendors flagged
AbuseIPDB	0% confidence; 8 reports; 3 reporters; latest report 7 months ago AbuseIPDB identified a whitelisted Cloudflare reverse proxy in 104.16.0.0/13; Cloudflare, Inc.; CDN; AS13335; San Francisco, US.
AlienVault OTX	22 pulses; 500+ passive DNS; 10 URLs; 5 files. OTX verdict Whitelisted; classification CDN. 500+ domains and 89 TLDs; related tags included malware, stealer, ClickFix and Vidar. OTX showed 57 domains in 7 days and 401 in 30 days. AV labels: Backdoor:MSIL/AsyncRAT.GG!MTB; Backdoor:Win32/LimeRat.YA!MTB; TrojanDropper:Win32/Muldrop.V!MTB; Win.Packed.Razy-9807129-0; ratio 5/5.
Analyst note	OTX tags and AV labels are feed-level context, not proof Cloudflare's shared IP hosted these malware families. Investigate associated domain/URL and correlate DNS observations with campaign timing.

Evidence interpretation: Inclusion in the public campaign IOC list is not independent confirmation of malicious activity. Correlate with DNS, URL, endpoint and time-based telemetry before taking action.

4. Correlation and Campaign Context

All four IPv4 indicators were listed in the same public FDC ClickFix/Vidar campaign pulse. The observed infrastructure divides into two broad groups:

Hosting-provider infrastructure: 78.46.199.184 (Hetzner) and 213.186.33.16 (OVH). Investigate the specific services, hostnames and timestamps associated with the campaign.

Shared CDN infrastructure: 172.67.148.28 and 104.21.55.125 (Cloudflare). Because these are shared reverse-proxy addresses, IP-only blocking or attribution is unsafe without domain, URL and DNS context.

The campaign pulse also contained domains and URLs that may provide the necessary pivot from shared IPs to campaign-specific infrastructure. Those indicators have not yet been analyzed here.

5. MITRE ATT&CK; Context from the Campaign Pulse

The following technique tags were present in the OTX pulse. They are campaign-level tags and have not been independently validated against endpoint telemetry in this investigation.

T1204.002	User Execution: Malicious File	User interaction / execution in the reported delivery chain.
T1059.001	Command and Scripting Interpreter: PowerShell	PowerShell execution context indicated by pulse tag.
T1027.013	Encrypted/Encoded File	Obfuscation or encoding context indicated by pulse tag.
T1140	Deobfuscate/Decode Files or Information	Decoding context indicated by pulse tag.
T1105	Ingress Tool Transfer	Retrieval or transfer of additional payloads.
T1036.005	Masquerading: Match Legitimate Name or Location	Masquerading context indicated by pulse tag.
T1584.001	Compromise Infrastructure: Domains	Domain infrastructure context indicated by pulse tag.
T1071.001	Application Layer Protocol: Web Protocols	HTTP/HTTPS communications context indicated by pulse tag.
T1070.004	Indicator Removal: File Deletion	File deletion context indicated by pulse tag.
T1564.003	Hide Artifacts: Hidden Window	Hidden-window execution context indicated by pulse tag.
T1555 / T1555.003	Credentials from Password Stores / Web Browsers	Credential access context indicated by pulse tags.
T1552.001	Unsecured Credentials: Credentials In Files	Credential discovery context indicated by pulse tag.
T1005	Data from Local System	Local data collection context indicated by pulse tag.
T1114	Email Collection	Email collection context indicated by pulse tag.

6. Recommendations and Remaining Work

1. Investigate the four campaign domains individually in VirusTotal and OTX. Use AbuseIPDB only where applicable; it is primarily IP-focused.
2. Investigate the three SHA-256 hashes using VirusTotal and OTX. Record file type, malware labels, first-seen/submission details and detection ratio only when displayed.
3. Review the two URLs as text in reputation portals; do not open them directly.
4. Perform passive DNS, WHOIS, ASN and SSL/TLS context checks for domains and correlate timestamps and hosting changes.
5. Build an IOC relationship diagram only where source data supports a relationship.
6. Complete risk classification after corroboration; retain Pending/Unknown where evidence is insufficient.

Operational caution: Do not block shared Cloudflare IPs based only on their appearance in the campaign pulse. If defensive action is warranted, prioritize verified domain/URL indicators and correlate with local DNS, proxy, firewall and endpoint logs.

7. Limitations

This report is based on user-transcribed portal observations rather than direct API exports or attached screenshots. Portal values may change over time. No independent re-query was performed while preparing this PDF. The investigation did not validate malware samples, execute payloads or establish direct victim telemetry. The public OTX pulse may contain stale or inaccurate associations. Refresh findings before operational use.

8. References

1. AlienVault OTX pulse: [FDC] ClickFix Social Engineering Campaign Delivering Vidar Stealer via Fake Cloudflare CAPTCHA. https://otx.alienvault.com/ (search the exact pulse title).

2. FDC Threat Intelligence, Incident Report, 27 March 2026: https://github.com/freedatacenter/threat-intelligence/blob/main/reports/2026-03-27-clickfix-vidar/Incident_Report_2026-03-27_EN.pdf

3. VirusTotal: https://www.virustotal.com/gui/

4. AbuseIPDB: https://www.abuseipdb.com/

Final analyst conclusion: The four IPs are present in the public ClickFix/Vidar campaign IOC set, but the evidence is heterogeneous. Two addresses are shared Cloudflare CDN proxies and should not be treated as confirmed malicious IPs. The remaining two show mixed reputation signals. Further domain-, URL-, hash- and endpoint-level correlation is required before final severity assignment or blocking.